

A faint, light gray map of Germany is visible in the background, showing the outlines of its 16 federal states. The map is centered and serves as a backdrop for the text.

Regional and Gender Differences regarding High-Income in Germany

Data from 2024



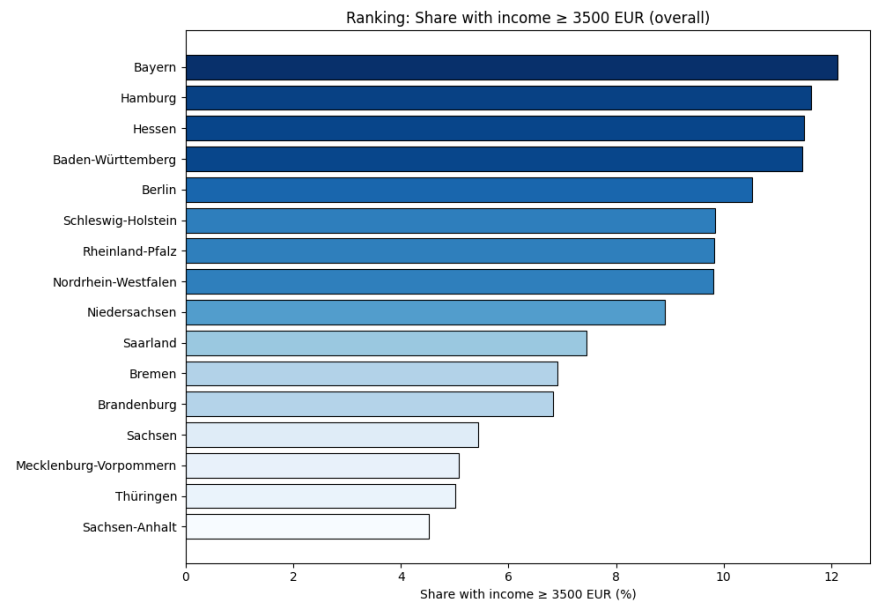
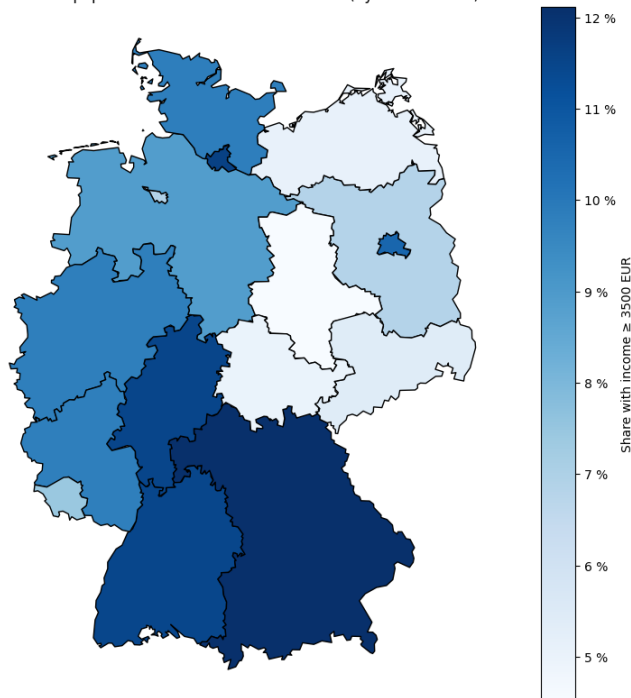
Research Questions

- How do high-income shares differ across German federal states?
- How large are gender gaps in access to high income, and how do they vary regionally?
- To what extent are income gender gaps related to differences in full-time work?

High-Income Shares Across Federal States

- High-income shares vary strongly between German federal states
- Southern and city states show the highest shares
- Lower shares cluster in eastern part of Germany
- The pattern broadly aligns with the historical East–West divide

Share of population with income ≥ 3500 EUR (by federal state)



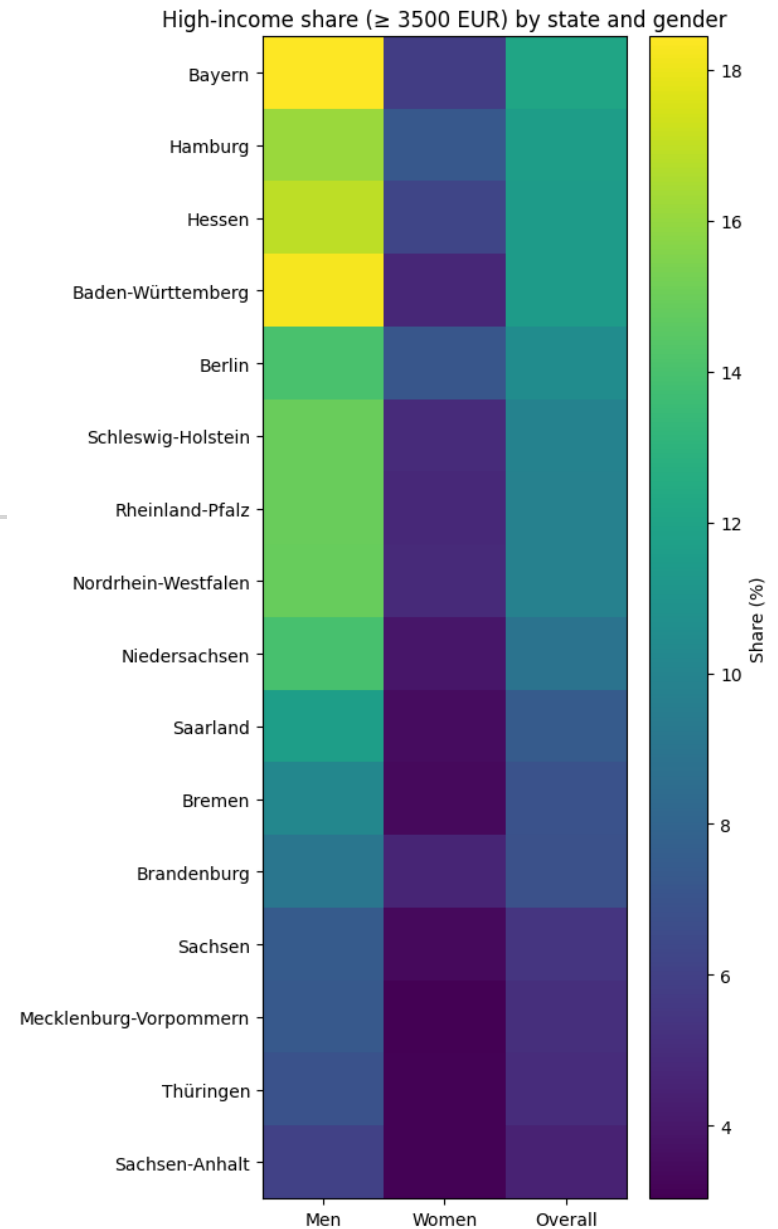
Historical Context

- Germany's historical division into East and West created long-lasting economic and labor-market differences
- After reunification, eastern regions started from lower wage levels and weaker industrial structures
- Headquarters and high-value industries remain concentrated in western and southern states
- These historical and structural patterns continue to shape regional income levels and opportunities today



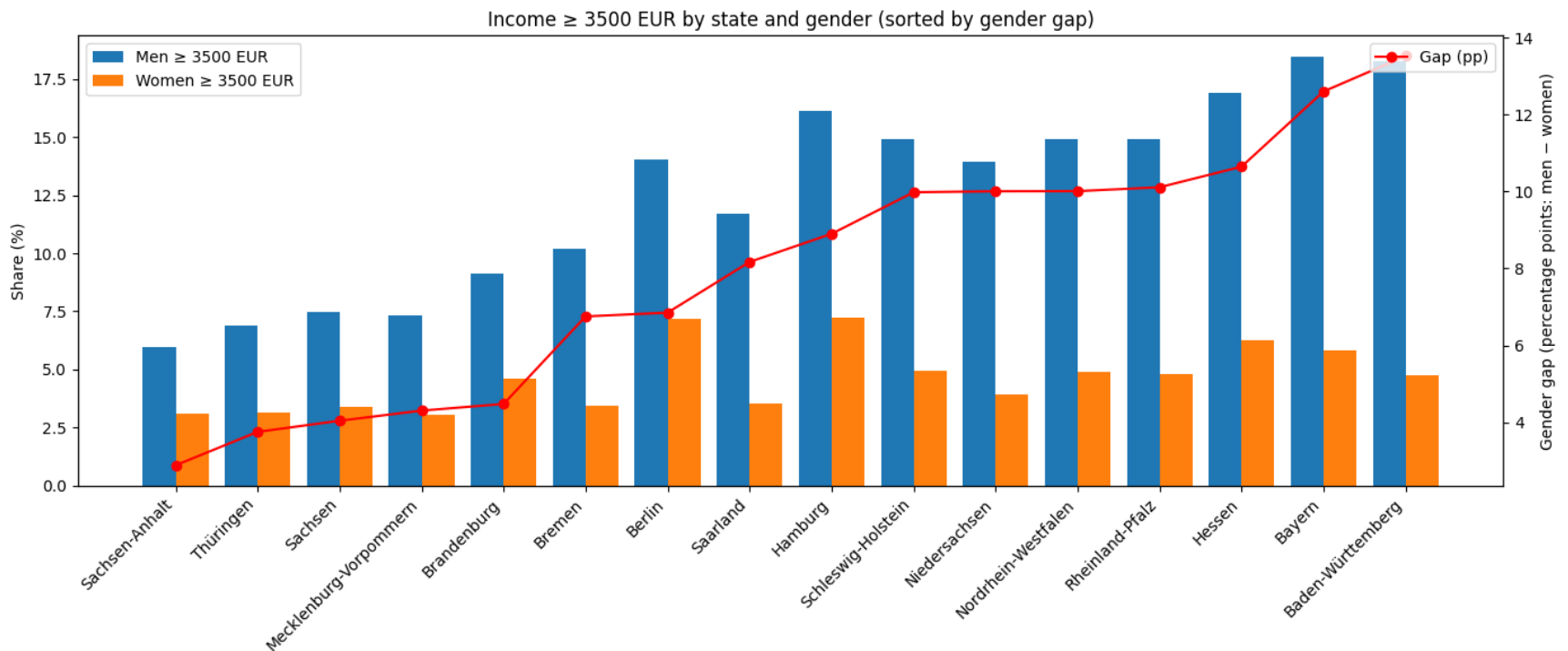
High-Income by Gender and State

- Men have higher high-income shares than women in all states
- Gender differences persist even in high-income regions
- Eastern states show lower shares overall
→ Less significant differences between genders



Ranking Federal States by Gender Income Gap

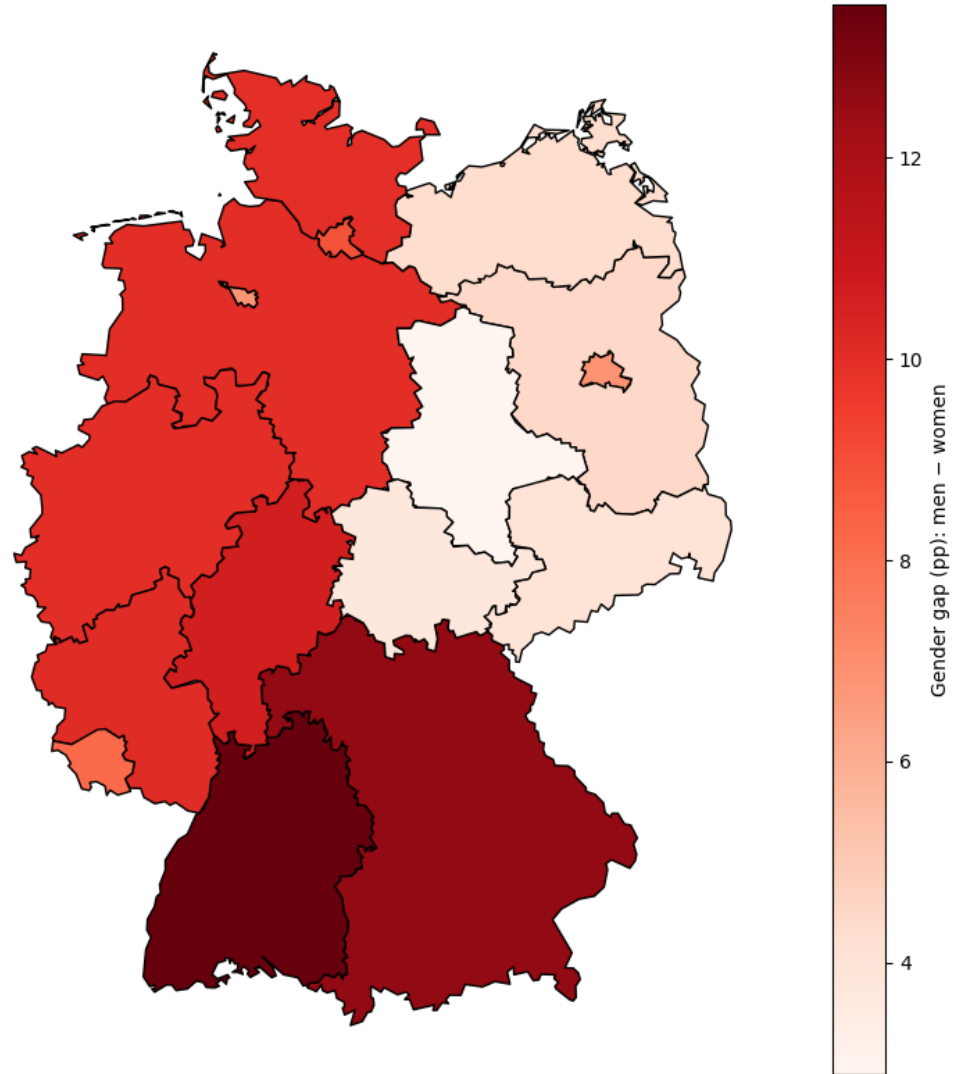
- Gender income gaps differ substantially across states
- Gaps correlate with overall income levels
- The two biggest cities have comparably low gap despite large high-income shares



Spatial Distribution of the Gender Income Gap

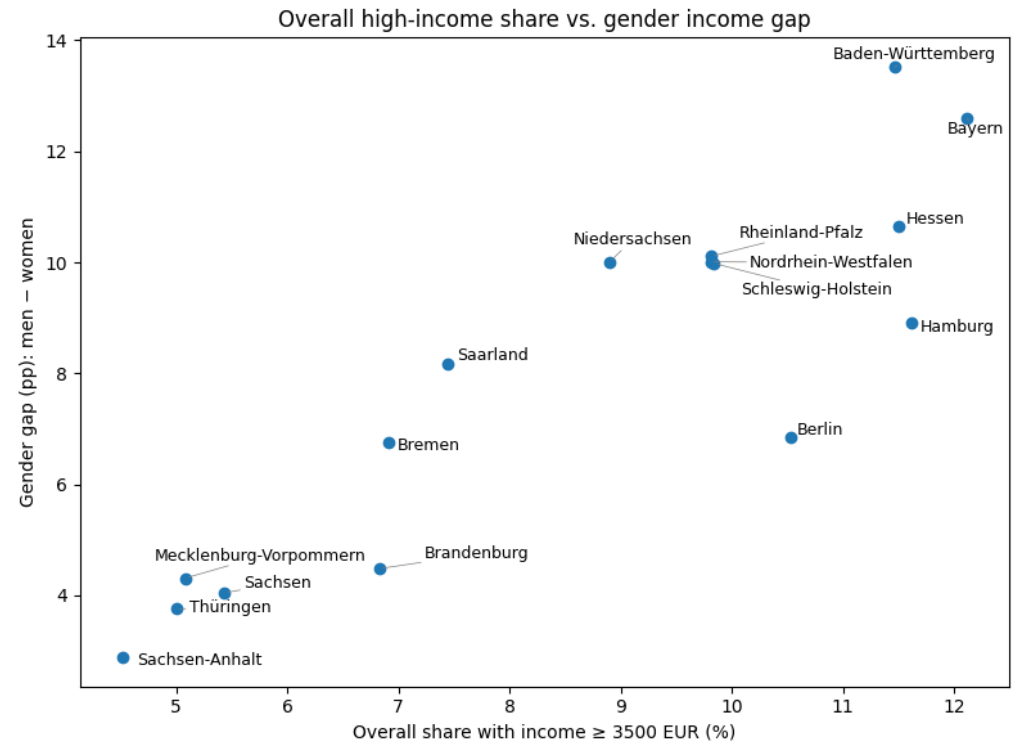
- Clear regional clustering of gender income gaps
- Southern states show comparatively large gaps
- Smaller gaps are observed in eastern States
- More egalitarian gender roles in eastern Germany

Gender gap in income ≥ 3500 EUR (men – women, percentage points)



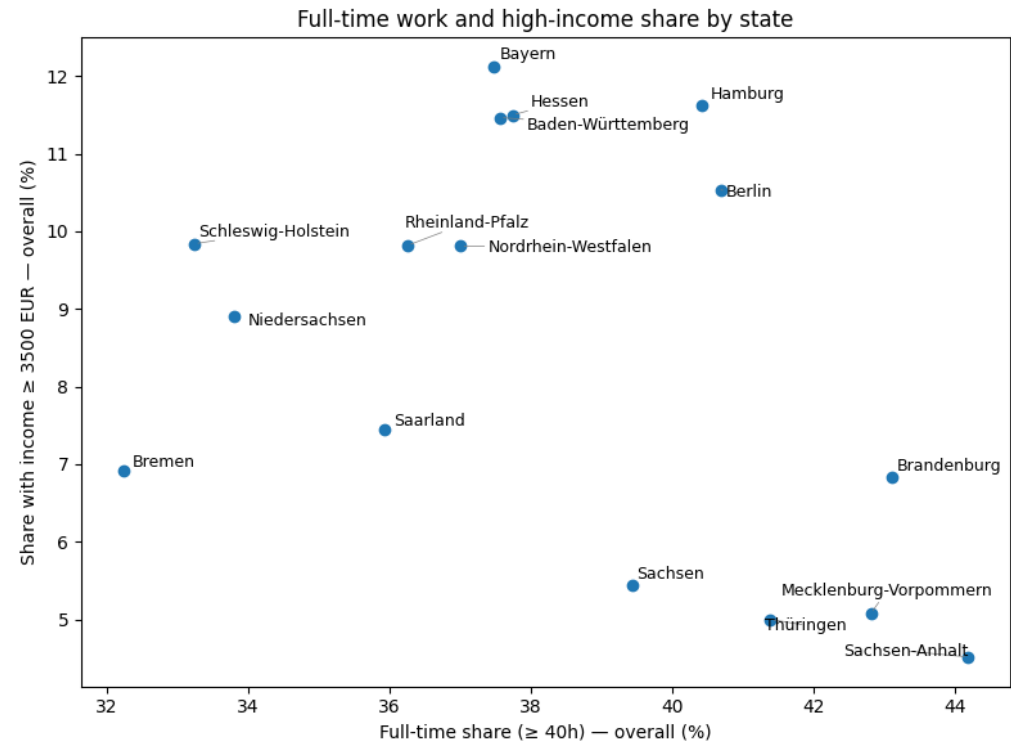
Income Level and Gender Income Gap

- Higher income shares correlate with larger gender gaps
- High income does not automatically imply gender equality
- The linear pattern suggests structural explanations



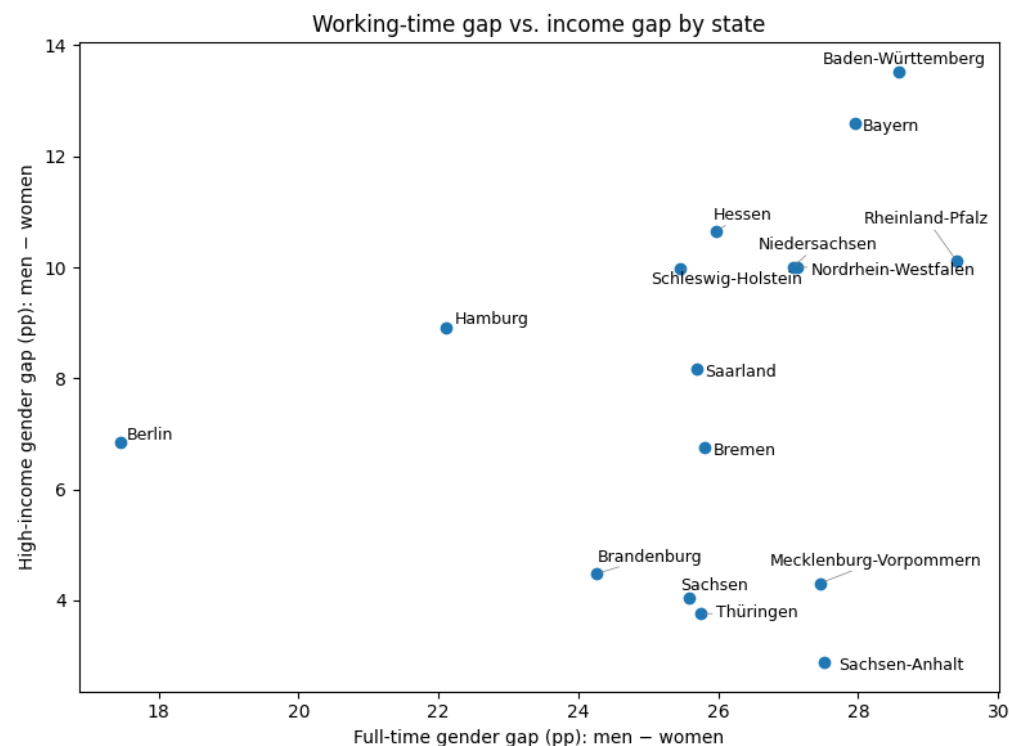
Full-Time Work and High-Income

- Higher full-time shares do not necessarily lead to higher income shares
- Some eastern states combine high full-time work with low high-income access
→ Low wage levels
- Wage levels matter, not only working time



Working-Time Gap and Gender Income Gap

- Larger full-time gender gaps relate to larger income gaps
- Working time is a key mechanism behind income inequality
- But it does not fully explain gender income gaps
- Raises questions about gender roles in German households



Key Takeaways

- Strong regional inequality in access to high-income
- Persistent gender income gaps across all states
- High-income regions often show larger gender gaps
- Working-time differences explain part of the gap
- Historical and structural factors remain important